MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS 2

Name: ..... **Date:** .....

Read the paragraph. The main idea is what the whole paragraph is about, in one sentence. The details are the facts that support it. Write the main idea in the top box and three supporting details below.

Why We Recycle

grades 3 to 4 · 93 words

Recycling turns old things into new things instead of trash. When a plastic bottle is recycled, it can become a fleece jacket or a park bench. Recycling paper saves trees, because new paper can be made from old paper instead of from wood. It also saves energy: making a can from recycled aluminum uses far less power than making one from new metal. Most of all, recycling keeps mountains of waste out of landfills, where it would sit for hundreds of years. A few minutes of sorting at home makes a real difference.

Main idea one sentence

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

Detail 2

Detail 3

Test your main idea: does every detail in the paragraph tell you more about it? If one does not fit, your main idea may be too narrow.

MAIN IDEA AND DETAILS 2 ANSWER KEY

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Main idea one sentence

Recycling is worth doing because it turns waste into useful things and protects the environment.

↓ ↓ ↓

Detail 1

Old plastic and paper become new products such as jackets, benches and paper.

Detail 2

Recycling saves trees and energy compared with making things from new materials.

Detail 3

It keeps huge amounts of waste out of landfills.